DESIGN FIRM
WEBSITE PLANNING GUIDE

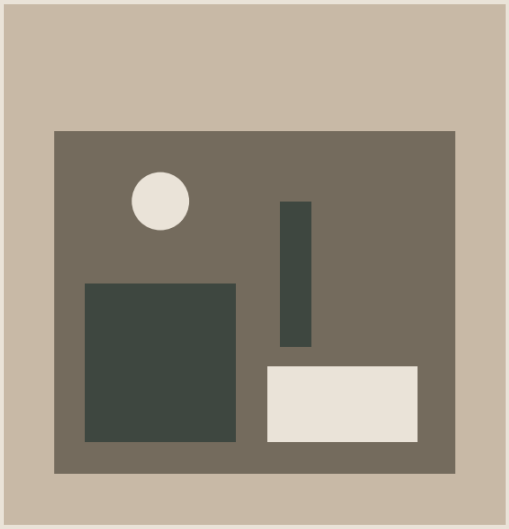
A complete content, portfolio, brand and website preparation handbook



Architecture & spatial design

Form • light • context

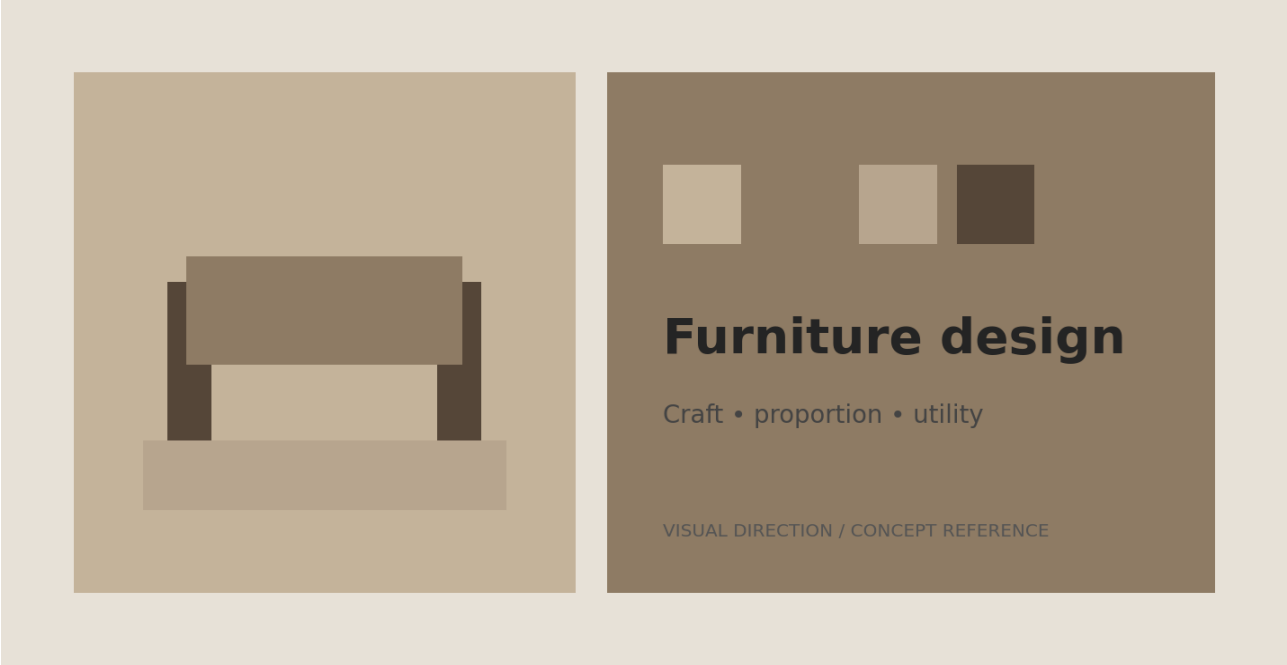
VISUAL DIRECTION / CONCEPT REFERENCE

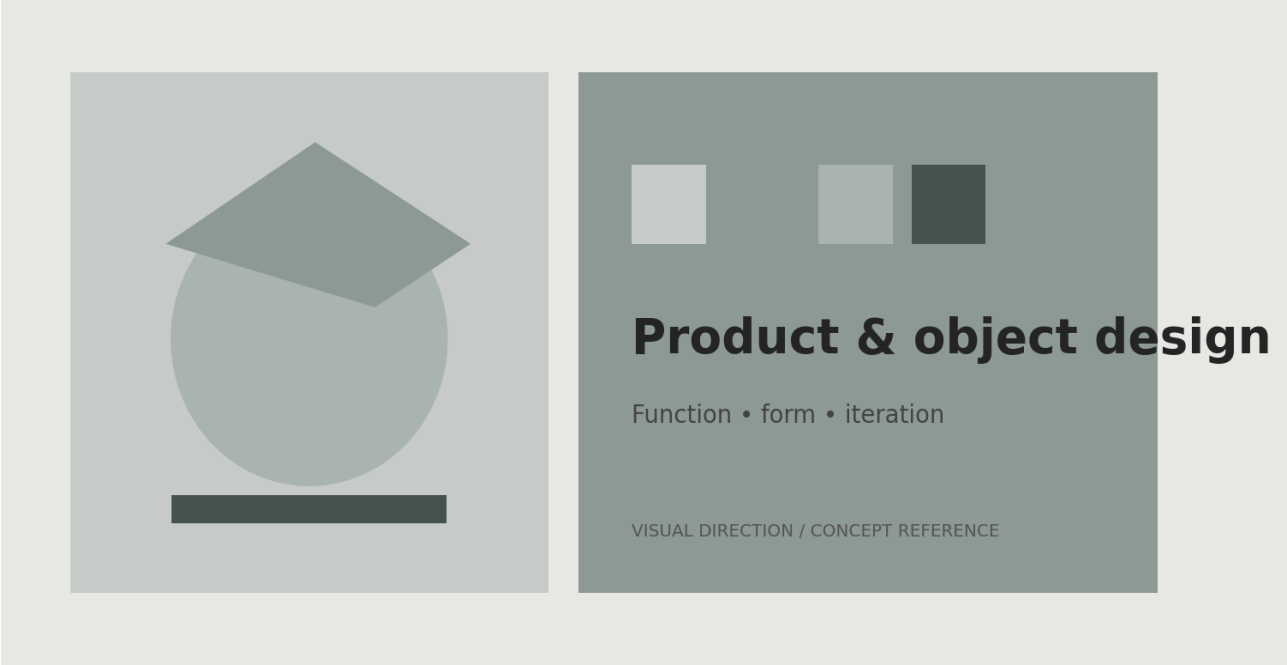


Interior design

Material • comfort • detail

VISUAL DIRECTION / CONCEPT REFERENCE





Prepared from the full planning discussion • 3 November 2026

How to use this guide

Use this document as a working brief. Replace illustrative examples with the firm's actual name, services, projects, credentials, locations and contact details. The visual panels are original concept references created for this guide; they are not photographs of completed projects.

1. Purpose and website strategy

Create a professional digital presence for a multidisciplinary design firm. The website should explain the practice, communicate its design philosophy, demonstrate the quality of its work, describe services, build trust, and generate qualified project enquiries.

The website should quickly answer three questions: Who are you? What do you design? Why should a potential client contact you?

2. Brand identity

Prepare the firm's official name, logo (primary, secondary and icon versions), tagline, brand story, design philosophy, mission, vision, values, brand personality, colour palette, typography, and any brand guidelines.

Possible brand positioning: a thoughtful, contemporary design practice working across architecture, interior environments, furniture, products and spatial experiences. This is an example direction, not a final brand statement.

Potential brand traits include minimal, sophisticated, functional, material-aware, sustainable, experimental, or craft-led. Select traits that genuinely describe the practice.

3. Homepage content

Hero section: a strong project image, firm name/logo, concise headline, supporting sentence, and clear calls to action such as Explore Projects or Start a Project.

Featured projects: showcase approximately 3–6 strong projects with title, category, location, year/status, and cover image.

Services overview: introduce the firm's principal services with concise descriptions and links to detail pages.

Studio introduction: a short explanation of the practice and its approach.

Contact prompt: make the next step clear, such as Discuss Your Project or Get in Touch.

4. About the studio

Prepare a studio introduction, founder profile, relevant education and professional experience, design philosophy, values, design process, collaborators/team information, and long-term vision.

Explain how the practice approaches people, space, material, context, function, craft, and sustainability. Keep all qualifications and experience accurate and verifiable.

Suggested philosophy starter: “We believe good design begins with understanding. By exploring the relationship between people, space, material, geometry and function, we develop design solutions that are purposeful, considered and enduring.” Adapt this to reflect the firm's real beliefs.

5. Services

Architecture and building design: residential and commercial concepts, planning, spatial organisation, façade concepts, design development, drawings and visualisation, where qualified and offered.

Interior architecture and interior design: residential, retail, office, hospitality and commercial interiors; space planning; furniture layouts; materials and finishes; lighting concepts; renovation and refurbishment.

Furniture design: bespoke, residential and commercial furniture; modular systems; prototyping; material, joinery and manufacturing development.

Product and industrial design: product concepts, functional objects, material exploration, 3D modelling, prototyping, visualisation and manufacturing-oriented development.

Spatial and experimental design: exhibition environments, installations, public-space furniture and small-scale spatial interventions.

Design consultancy and visualisation: concept development, 3D modelling, architectural/furniture rendering, design presentations and design-development support.

For each service explain: what it includes, who it is for, expected deliverables, and how to enquire. Only list services the firm is genuinely able and authorised to provide.

6. Portfolio and project pages

The portfolio is often the most persuasive part of a design firm's website. It should show both the finished work and the thinking behind it.

For each project collect: title; category; location; year; status (concept, in development or completed); client (only with permission); project area if relevant; brief; design challenge; concept; research; design development; materials/finishes; final outcome; and the creator's exact role.

Useful visual material: one strong cover image; overall views; detail views; sketches; plans/elevations/sections; diagrams; material palettes; 3D renders; photographs; physical models; prototypes; and before/after images where relevant.

An initial portfolio could contain 6–10 strong projects if available. A smaller, carefully curated portfolio is better than a large collection of weak or repetitive work.

Clearly label academic, personal, conceptual, commissioned and completed projects. Do not publish confidential client/employer material or work restricted by an NDA without permission.

7. Design process

Stage 01 — Understand: client discussion, project brief, site/user analysis, requirements and constraints.

Stage 02 — Research: context, precedents, materials, user needs and functional requirements.

Stage 03 — Concept development: sketches, design concepts, spatial planning and form exploration.

Stage 04 — Design development: drawings, models, material/finish selection, 3D visualisation and refinement.

Stage 05 — Delivery: agreed design documentation, technical coordination, prototyping or implementation support where included in the scope.

Be explicit about whether the firm provides design only, technical documentation, procurement, site supervision, turnkey execution, or implementation support.

8. Contact and project enquiry

Prepare a business email, phone number, optional WhatsApp contact, public studio address if applicable, service regions, social profiles, and a contact form.

Suggested enquiry fields: full name; email; optional phone; project type; project location; approximate area (where relevant); optional budget range; expected timeline; project description; and optional file upload for plans, photographs or references.

Include a privacy notice explaining how enquiry information is collected and used. Make the form easy to complete and avoid requesting unnecessary personal data.

9. Journal and insights

An optional journal can publish useful, original articles on interior design principles, small-space planning, sustainable materials, furniture design, design research, architecture, material experimentation, product development and design education.

Example topics: “Designing Small Homes: Principles of Space Planning”; “Material Selection in Contemporary Interiors”; “From Sketch to Prototype: The Furniture Design Process”; and “Sustainable Materials in Interior Architecture”.

Publish only content the firm can stand behind, and use project images or third-party material only when permitted.

10. Assets and technical requirements

Brand assets: logo in SVG or high-resolution PNG, colour codes, font names/licences and brand guidelines.

Project assets: high-resolution photographs, renders, drawings, plans, diagrams, sketches, models, prototypes and captions/credits.

Business information: official firm name, business contact details, service locations, social profiles and relevant registration/licensing details where applicable.

Technical requirements: domain, hosting or website platform, mobile-responsive layout, HTTPS, accessible navigation, contact form, optimised images, SEO metadata, analytics if desired, privacy policy and other applicable legal notices.

A portfolio website can be created before company registration, but do not claim registrations, licences or credentials that the firm does not hold.

11. Search engine optimisation

For each key page prepare a clear page title, concise meta description, primary search phrase, readable URL, meaningful image alt text, original project description, relevant internal links and accurate location/service-area information.

Example page title: “Residential Interior Design in Ahmedabad | [Firm Name]” — use only if the firm genuinely offers that service in that location.

Avoid keyword stuffing. Clear, useful page content and accurate service information are more important than repeating search phrases.

12. Recommended website sitemap

HOME

ABOUT THE STUDIO — Studio Introduction; Founder Profile; Design Philosophy; Design Process

PROJECTS — Architecture; Interior Design; Retail & Commercial; Furniture Design; Product Design

SERVICES — Architecture & Building Design; Interior Architecture & Design; Furniture Design; Product Design; Design Consultancy

JOURNAL — Design Insights; Materials & Sustainability; Design Research

CONTACT — Project Enquiry; Email & Telephone; Social Media

PRIVACY POLICY

This can be simplified for launch. Separate pages are not required for every service or portfolio category on day one.

13. Website preparation checklist

01 Brand Identity — firm name, logo, colours, fonts and tagline.

02 Studio Profile — about text, story, philosophy and founder profile.

03 Portfolio — selected projects, images, drawings and descriptions.

04 Services — service descriptions, scope and deliverables.

05 Contact — email, phone, location and social profiles.

06 Website Copy — headlines, page descriptions, buttons and captions.

07 SEO — page titles, keywords, meta descriptions and image alt text.

08 Journal — articles and research-based content (optional at launch).

09 Testimonials — genuine client feedback with permission (optional).

10 Technical — domain, platform, hosting, security and analytics.

14. Decisions to finalise before design

Firm name: confirm the official name and whether the brand name is still being explored.

Services: select the disciplines the firm will actually offer.

Target clients: residential clients, commercial businesses, property developers, furniture manufacturers/design brands, international clients, or a combination.

Visual style: minimal luxury; contemporary architectural; warm and natural; or experimental and creative.

Geographic focus: Ahmedabad/Gujarat; all India; India and UAE; or international.

First deliverable: complete website copy; sitemap and page planning; visual design and homepage layout; or end-to-end website planning including content, visual direction and development.

15. Suggested next steps

Step 1: Finalise the firm name, positioning and service list.

Step 2: Gather and curate portfolio projects, confirming permissions and project credits.

Step 3: Prepare the studio profile, founder biography, design philosophy and service descriptions.

Step 4: Select the visual direction, typography, colours and image treatment.

Step 5: Build the sitemap and write page-by-page content.

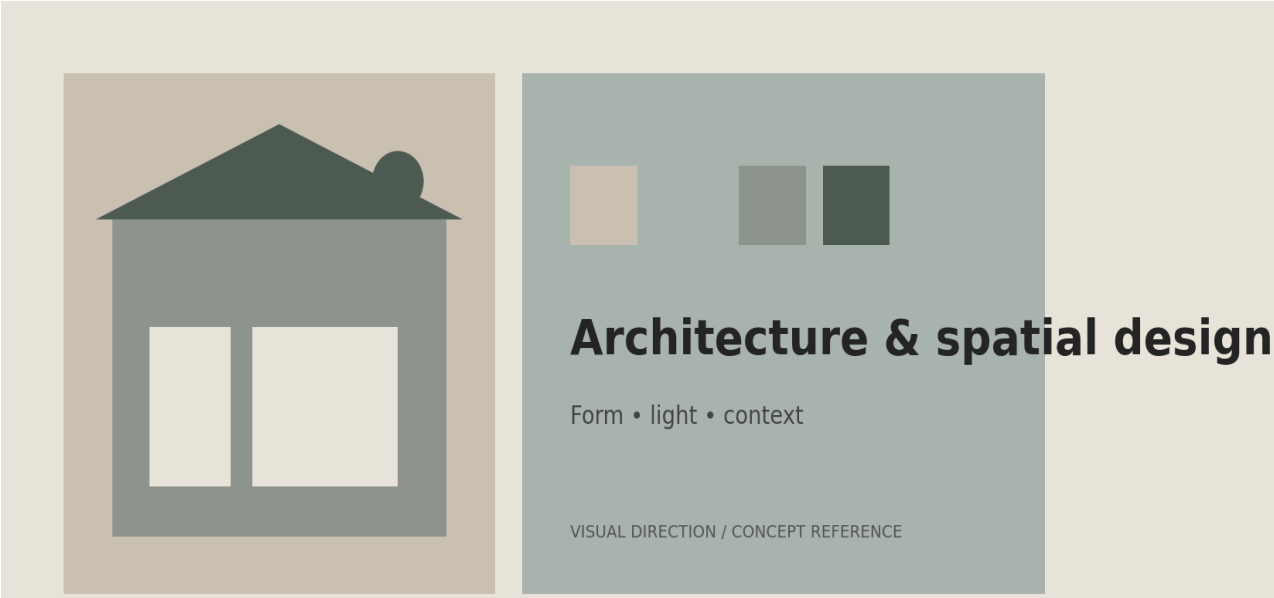
Step 6: Design the responsive website and implement enquiry functionality.

Step 7: Review content accuracy, accessibility, mobile behaviour, privacy notices and SEO before launch.

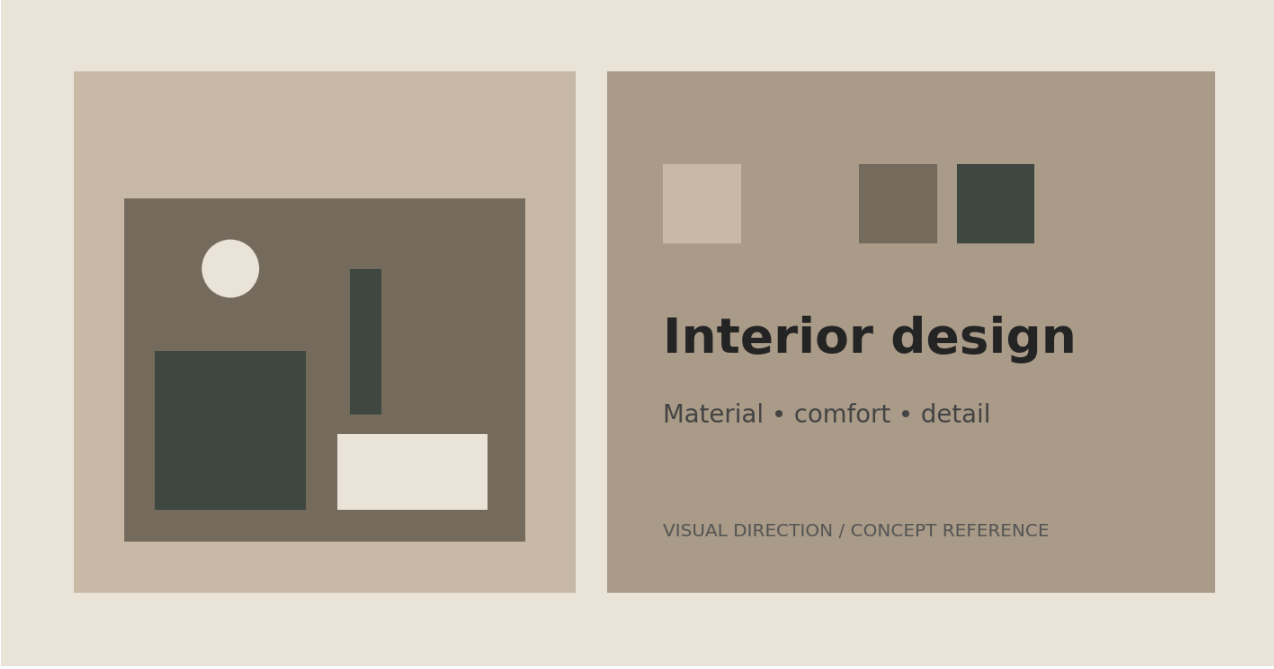
Visual reference panels

These original abstract panels suggest possible visual directions for the four core design disciplines. They are mood-setting illustrations, not finished portfolio work.

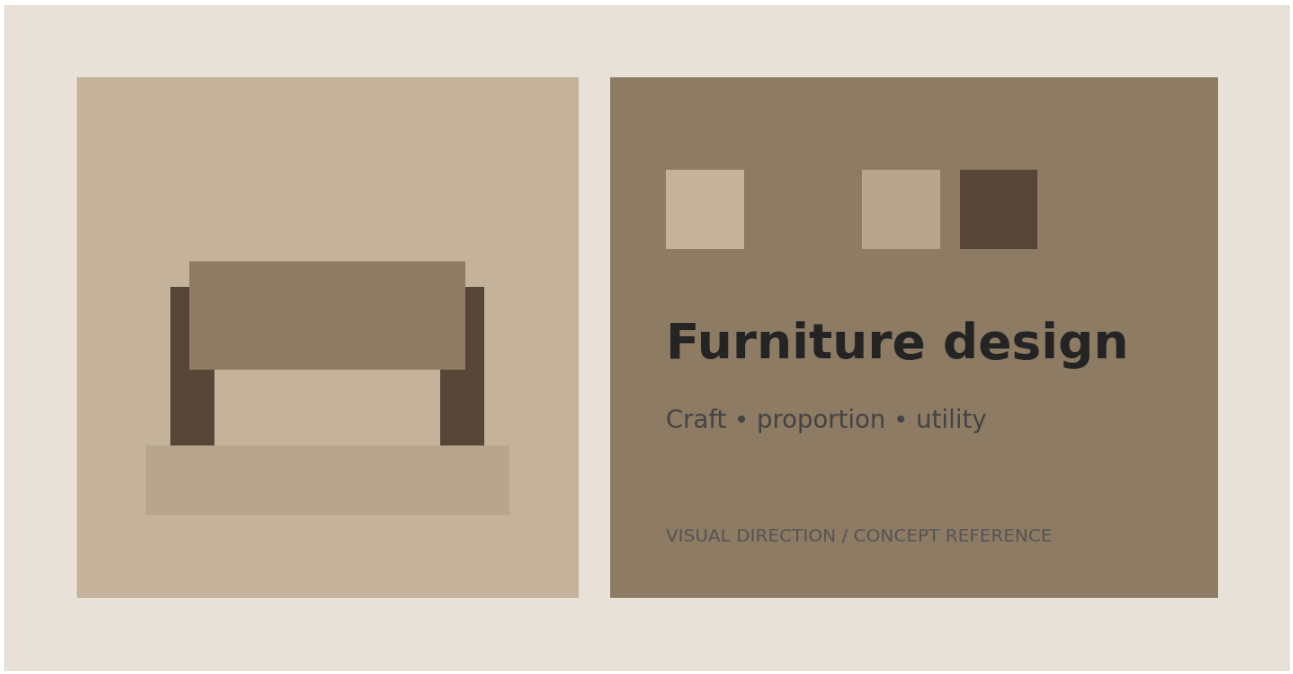
Architecture & spatial design



Interior design



Furniture design



Product & object design

